

Global development

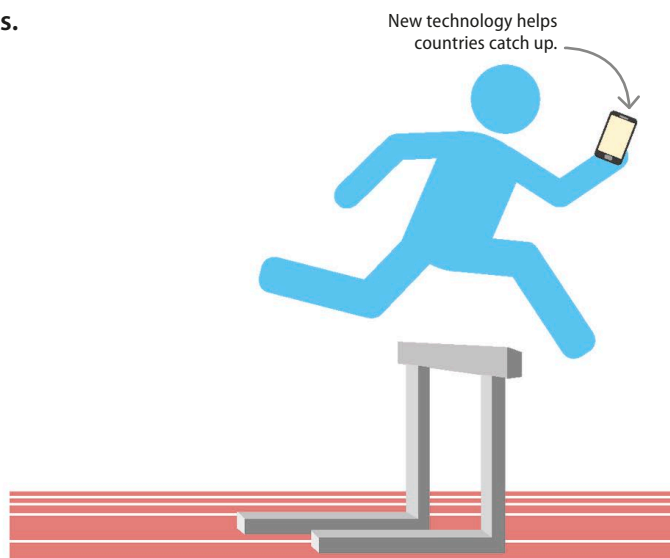
Though digital technology has spread across the world, people in developing countries often experience significantly fewer benefits from it than those in developed countries.

A connected world

More than two billion people have access to the internet, and five billion have mobile phones. However, these people are not spread evenly across the globe. Most people in Europe have access to the internet, while many in Africa do not. This situation is known as the global digital divide. This divide presents both challenges and opportunities as the world becomes ever more connected.

► Shortcuts

Developing countries are sometimes able to reduce the digital divide quicker by using the technology of the developed world. This effectively allows them to leapfrog over years of development and obsolete technology.



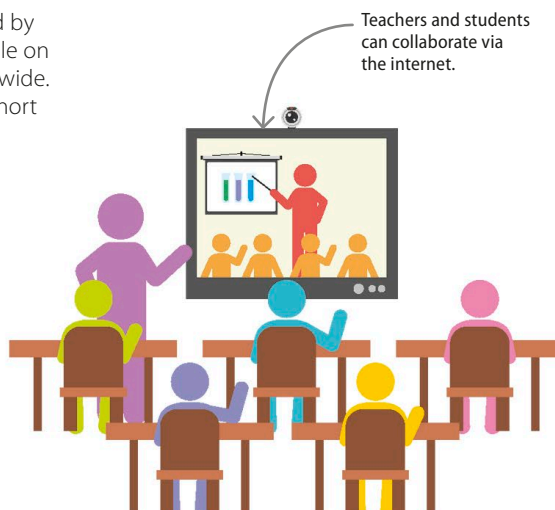
Potential for good

There is great potential for vastly improving people's lives across the world by using digital technologies. There are huge amounts of information available on the internet, and wider access has the power to improve education worldwide. Additionally, the ability to gather a lot of data from people in a relatively short amount of time via smart devices and the internet is crucial. This data can help governments and organizations react to problems and crises, from how best to help people after a natural disaster, to understanding how to distribute crucial resources.



△ Ending hunger

Hundreds of millions of people across the world are suffering from hunger. Digital technology opens up new possibilities for improving crop yields and co-ordinating distribution, potentially helping to lessen and even end this problem.



△ Education for all

Teachers, students, and parents can access online resources and libraries that wouldn't be available otherwise. They're able to connect with other educators and learners through communities and forums on the web.

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◀ 212–213 Net neutrality

◀ 214–215 Digital divide